

To the Editors,

I am writing to submit our manuscript titled "Candidate Instruments for a Universal Carbon Premium: The Commonwealth Cost of Carbon" for consideration as a Perspectives article in Environmental Science and Policy. This submission was presented at the 3rd International Conference on Environment and Sustainable Development.

The manuscript provides a timely, critical evaluation of basic theory towards discovery of a universal ecosystem performance observation. Specifically, this article argues that following the Hobbesian position allows one to estimate a "Commonwealth Cost of Carbon" using simple and elegant methods that do not require privileged information or expert computation. Not only could this novel insight yield benefits for worldwide civic participation, but also allows a history of carbon premiums to be estimated with much higher certainty than competing views. By bridging the gap between climate science and practical application, our piece offers actionable advances for a new trade association called the "Commonwealth of Peoples" and introduces a new "Commonwealth Service Rating" instrument to inspire a new marketplace in service performance.

We believe this manuscript is an ideal fit for Environmental Science and Policy because it directly aligns with the journal's emphasis on the intersections between environmental science, policy and society. It specifically addresses your audiences interest in analyses of decision making practices in government, civil society and businesses and the ways that they engage environmental knowledge.

By submitting this work, I confirm that:

- The manuscript is original and is not currently under consideration for publication elsewhere.
- All authors have approved the final manuscript and agree to its submission to Ecological Economics.
- There are no conflicts of interest to disclose.

Thank you very much for your time and consideration of our work.

Best wishes,

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